Emily Thao

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linkedin.com/in/emily-thao/ | Portfolio

Academic Background

University of Wisconsin-Madison Madison, WI — Sept. 2022 – May 2026 (Expected)

- Bachelor of Science in **Computer Science** and **Information Science**
- Certificates in: Game Design, Asian American Studies, and Digital Studies
- Full tuition scholarship: Mercile J. Lee Scholars Program (MJLSP)
    - MJLSP Hackathon (participated in Spring 2024, assisted with program in Spring 2025)
    - Big Sibling (2024 – current): assisting new MJLSP students with adapting to UW-Madison Campus

Professional Experience

University of Wisconsin-Madison Madison, WI — Oct. 2023 – May 2025
Communications + Social Media Intern for MJLSP

- Designed 30+ assets, flyers, and IG posts for Freshman and Sophomore cohorts — Fall 2023 – Spring 2024
- Promoted UW-Madison to 45+ students and parents at college fairs and on campus — Fall 2023
- Most recent design work for program-wide projects including: — Fall 2024 – Spring 2025
    - Level Up: GTA crew necks (250+ attendees)
    - Cohort stickers: stickers for each cohort year (350+ scholars)
    - Timeline project: historical record for MJLSP's 40th anniversary
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Northwestern Mutual Milwaukee, WI — May 2022 – Aug. 2023
Software Engineer Intern

- hi-Tech Minicamp: introduction to web development with **HTML, CSS, JS, React** — Summer 2022
- Part-time internship: fulfilled web page updates and outlined email templates — Fall 2022 – Spring 2023
- College Internship: **C#** search and replace program, bookmarking feature — Summer 2023
- Practiced **scrum** skills by holding 50+ meetings, including demonstrations for stakeholders and departments

Skills & More

- External scholarships: Dell Scholar, APIA Scholar
    - APIA Scholar: serving as a Career Development Committee member on the Scholarship Advisory Committee for 2025-2026 academic year
- Language: English (fluent), Hmong (proficient)
    - UW Hmong Studies in Thailand (June 2025): served as a translator during homestays
- Web design: Hmong Generational Trauma
- Artwork and more: Personal Portfolio (including Game Design, HCI, 3D modeling works)
- Game design: Itch.io